



Chöjuk Chöpa

The Bodhicaryāvatāra Offering

Origins and meaning

Our unsurpassed Teacher, Buddha Śākyamuni, the protector and refuge of all sentient beings, taught boundless and sublime Dharma teachings in order to guide all beings beyond the ocean of suffering of saṃsāra. At the very heart and essence of Mahāyāna Buddhism lies the cultivation and practice of bodhicitta—the mind of awakening.

Sometime in the first half of the eighth century CE, the great Indian accomplished master and bodhisattva Śāntideva taught the Bodhicaryāvatāra (The Way of the Bodhisattva) to the assembly at Nālandā Monastery. Since then, this profound treatise has been transmitted to the present day and has come to hold an exceptionally important place within traditions of actual practice.

In the nineteenth century, the great Nyingma master Patrul Rinpoche established and strongly promoted a distinctive practice tradition in Tibet known in Tibetan as Chöjuk Chöpa.

“Chöjuk” is the abbreviated Tibetan title of the Bodhicaryāvatāra, while “Chöpa” means “offering.” Thus, this practice tradition may be understood as a Dharma offering of the Bodhicaryāvatāra.

Patrul Rinpoche regarded the Bodhicaryāvatāra as one of the most important treatises of the Mahāyāna and placed particular emphasis on its study, contemplation, and actual practice.

The traditional practice

Traditionally, during this Dharma assembly, an extensive and magnificent array of offerings is arranged. Each morning begins with renewing or recollecting the bodhisattva vows, after which the assembly recites and practices the text chapter by chapter.

In the extensive form of the practice, the entire Bodhicaryāvatāra is recited from beginning to end. In the concise form, the practice focuses primarily on four chapters:

- Chapter One: The Benefits of Bodhicitta
- Chapter Two: Confession
- Chapter Three: Taking Hold of Bodhicitta
- Chapter Ten: Dedication

This sublime and beautiful tradition of practice continues to be observed annually at some Tibetan Buddhist monasteries in Tibet today.

An annual gathering and the practice of bodhicitta

Beginning this year, with the gathering on October 10, 11, and 12, 2026, I very much hope that we can establish this Dharma assembly as our annual Bodhicitta Dharma Offering Gathering. May those who have the karmic connection join together in making the aspiration to hold this practice for three consecutive days each year, so that this pure and precious tradition may be sustained here in North America for many years to come.

For anyone who wishes to understand bodhicitta, cultivate bodhicitta, and truly put bodhicitta into practice, The Bodhicaryāvatāra Offering is of immense benefit.

The Bodhicaryāvatāra teaches us in a concrete and comprehensive way how to give rise to bodhicitta within our own minds, how to embody bodhicitta in our speech and actions, and how to integrate bodhicitta into every aspect of our daily lives.

This Dharma assembly will follow the traditional format of four practice sessions each day. During each session, Khenchen Sherab Sangpo Rinpoche will personally guide and lead everyone in meditation. In this way, we will not merely recite the text, but will also engage with its meaning, actually cultivate bodhicitta in meditation, and gradually integrate the instructions of the Bodhicaryāvatāra into our own mindstreams.

A pure and unbroken lineage

We are especially fortunate because the teachings we receive today come through a precious, pure, and unbroken lineage.

The lineage from Patrul Rinpoche to His Holiness Khenchen Pema Tsewang Rinpoche is exceptionally close, with only two lineage masters between them. One is Khenchen Yönga (Yönten Gyatso), a direct disciple of Patrul Rinpoche. The other is Khenchen Thupten Chöphel, also known as Thubga Yishyin Norbu (“Wish-Fulfilling Jewel”).

The sequence of transmission is:

Patrul Rinpoche

→ Khenchen Yönga (Yönten Gyatso)

→ Khenchen Thupten Chöphel, also known as Thubga Yishyin Norbu (“Wish-Fulfilling Jewel”)

→ His Holiness Khenchen Pema Tsewang Rinpoche

This also illustrates why Buddhism places such great importance on the purity of lineage and transmission.

These teachings have not simply been read from books and then retold to us. Rather, generation after generation, the lineage masters themselves personally studied and contemplated these teachings, put them into actual practice, and attained corresponding realization and accomplishment. Only then were the teachings passed from master to disciple, generation after generation, in a pure and unerring transmission that has continued to the present day.

We have the privilege of personally receiving this sublime and pure transmission.

Through this living lineage of realization and practical experience, we receive not only the words and Dharma meaning of the Bodhicaryāvatāra, but also the blessings of the lineage masters and the practical experience they have passed down from generation to generation.

The meaning of Dharma offering

For this reason, this Dharma assembly is not merely an occasion for reciting a Buddhist text. It is a very precious opportunity for actual Dharma practice.

Through this group practice, we can once again recollect and strengthen our bodhisattva resolve, reconnect with the pure lineage, and further deepen our understanding and practice of bodhicitta. At the same time, we can offer our study and contemplation, recitation, and actual practice as a Dharma offering, and dedicate the merit to all sentient beings, with the aspiration that they may attain both temporary happiness and ultimate liberation.

For disciples of the Buddha, there is no more sublime way to repay the kindness of the Buddha and the kindness of our parents than to practice bodhicitta and make a Dharma offering through the practice of bodhicitta.

Likewise, there is no more sublime practice than bodhicitta for accomplishing both temporary and ultimate happiness, leading us toward liberation and ultimately to the attainment of buddhahood. Whether for our own benefit or for the benefit of others, there is no practice more direct or more complete than bodhicitta.

Therefore, I sincerely hope that every Buddhist practitioner who possesses the necessary causes, conditions, and merit will not miss this essential and precious traditional group practice.

A Bodhicitta Dharma Offering Gathering of this kind is rarely held overseas. Whether one studies and practices the sūtra teachings or the tantric teachings, all disciples of the Buddha who have taken refuge in the Three Jewels and are able to uphold their precepts with purity are welcome to participate.